

R4 Structured Reflection Templates

Pillar	Reflection	Difficulty	Level 1
Time Required	20 minutes (selection), then 10-15 minutes per use	Group Size	Individual or team
Mode	Resource provision (manager distributes, individuals use)	Format	Any
Prerequisites	None	CLOVER ERA Trigger	Lack of structured reflection practices, reflections staying surface-level, teams not knowing how to reflect productively

Why This Works

THE NEUROSCIENCE

Unstructured reflection often produces rumination rather than insight. Without a framework, the brain tends to replay events emotionally (amygdala-driven) rather than process them analytically (prefrontal cortex-driven). Templates provide the cognitive scaffolding that keeps reflection productive: they direct attention to specific aspects of experience and prevent the spiral into either self-criticism or self-congratulation.

The Templates

Select the template that matches the reflection context. Each template takes 10-15 minutes.

Template A: After Action Review (for completed projects or milestones)

Question	Guidance
What did we set out to do?	State the original objective clearly. Not the outcome, the intention.
What actually happened?	Facts, not interpretations. What occurred, in what sequence, with what results?
Why did it happen that way?	Root causes, not surface explanations. Ask 'why' at least twice to get beneath the obvious.
What will we do differently?	Specific, actionable changes. Not 'communicate better' but 'send a written brief before the meeting next time.'

Template B: The Energy Audit (for weekly reflection)

Question	Guidance
What gave me energy this week?	Tasks, interactions, or moments that left you feeling engaged and motivated.
What drained my energy?	Tasks, interactions, or patterns that left you depleted or frustrated.
What's the ratio?	Roughly, what percentage of your week was energising vs. draining? Is the ratio sustainable?
What one thing could shift the ratio?	One specific, doable change that would increase energy or reduce drain next week.

Template C: The Decision Debrief (for a specific decision)

Question	Guidance
What was the decision?	State it precisely. What were the options? What did you choose?
What information did I have?	What did you know at the time? What didn't you know that would have helped?
What influenced my choice?	Data, intuition, pressure, habit, advice from others? Be honest about the real drivers.
Knowing what I know now?	Would I make the same decision? If not, what would I change and why?

Template D: The Relationship Check (for team dynamics)

Question	Guidance
Who did I work well with this week?	Name specific interactions that felt productive and connected.
Where was there friction?	Specific moments of tension, misunderstanding, or disconnection.
What was my contribution to both?	Not what others did. What did I bring to the positive interactions and the difficult ones?
One thing I'll do differently in my next interaction with the friction source?	Specific, within your control. Not 'I hope they change.'

Cross-Pillar Connections

Worksheet	Connection	Direction
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R1: Micro-Reflection	R1 provides the daily habit; R4 provides the structured frameworks for deeper weekly/project reflection.	Complementary
R2: From Ideas to Action	Template outputs (especially the 'what will I do differently' questions) feed directly into R2's implementation intentions.	R4 feeds into R2
V2: Failure Stories	Template A (After Action Review) provides the structure for processing failures identified in V2.	Complementary